

Eat My Body and Drink My Blood III

From the attributes of God, we found that He is immutable. He cannot change or be changed. You, I, the devil, and all creation have no power to alter Him. He is sovereign, and He is sovereignly love, sovereignly just, and sovereignly immutable.

When Paul explained salvation to Gentiles, he had to answer the Jewish struggle: how could swine-eating Gentiles who had never kept a day in the law come into the same inheritance promised through Abraham?

Paul said that if the Gentile, by the new nature, keeps the law, that becomes circumcision to him. The Jew who has the law by letter but no new nature cannot keep it, and his circumcision becomes uncircumcision. The true Jew is circumcised in heart: the old man has been cut away and the new man has come into place.

Paul's ministry was to show that the law could not save, and he came just in time to establish the Church's foundation when legalism was trying to pull it back under bondage.

God is no respecter of persons. Every act He has ever performed in every dispensation has been for the good of all, not favoritism toward one man or nation over another.

When God told Moses to stand before Pharaoh, He said:

"Let my firstborn go."

That firstborn was being carried in the seed promised to Abraham. The seed was under bondage. God protected Israel because the salvation of the whole world was carried in that nation.

When Israel would not judge itself and keep under the covenant of blood so God could work in its midst, God sent Gentile nations to judge it until it returned. Even that was not favoritism against Israel; it was for the good of the whole world because the Seed had to come.

Understanding that God has never acted as a respecter of persons gives me more faith than I have ever had. I know He is not a man that He should lie. He is sovereignly immutable, and so is His Word. When He says something and I believe it, I have it.

After Noah landed, he sacrificed from the clean animals and birds brought onto the ark. God then explained that the life was in the blood. Whether an animal was killed for food or offered as a burnt offering, they were not to drink the blood. The blood was for atonement.

Later, under the Levitical priesthood, the blood was to be poured out and buried. The life was in the blood, and it was given for the atonement of the soul.

The priesthood slaughtered hundreds of thousands of gallons of blood over time. At the dedication of Solomon's temple, the sacrifices were immense. If that was the shadow, imagine the force of the true.

So you can understand the Jew's shock when Jesus said, "Unless you drink My blood and eat My flesh, you have no life in you." It sounded as though He contradicted a direct commandment.

John 6:47-51 says:

"Verily, verily, I say unto you,
He that believeth on me
hath everlasting life.
I am that bread of life.
Your fathers did eat manna in the wilderness,
and are dead.
This is the bread which cometh down from heaven,
that a man may eat thereof,
and not die."

When Jesus says the fathers ate manna and are dead, mark "dead" as spiritually dead. They ate manna in the wilderness, but manna could not give life to the human spirit.

Jesus continues:

"I am the living bread
which came down from heaven:
if any man eat of this bread,
he shall live for ever:
and the bread that I will give
is my flesh,
which I will give for the life of the world."

The Jews asked how He could give them His flesh to eat. Jesus made the saying harder:

"Except ye eat the flesh of the Son of man,
and drink his blood,
ye have no life in you."

Drinking His blood refers to receiving the life represented in the blood. Eating His flesh also points to the resurrection of the body. We receive His life in our spirit now, and we will be raised with glorified bodies in the last day.

John 6:56-57 says:

"He that eateth my flesh,
and drinketh my blood,
dwelleth in me,
and I in him.
As the living Father hath sent me,
and I live by the Father:
so he that eateth me,
even he shall live by me."

The life Jesus lived by was the life the Father gave Him. As the Father had life in Himself, He gave to the Son to have life in Himself. Then the Son gave that life to us.

When we drink His blood, in the truth behind the type, we receive the life that was in Him. We live by Him.

John 6:60-63 says many of His disciples said:

"This is an hard saying;
who can hear it?"

Jesus answered:

"Doth this offend you?
What and if ye shall see the Son of man
ascend up where he was before?
It is the spirit that quickeneth;
the flesh profiteth nothing:
the words that I speak unto you,
they are spirit,
and they are life."

The "spirit" here is the human spirit, not the Holy Spirit. The flesh profits nothing. Manna did not quicken. Animal blood did not quicken. Life comes into the human spirit.

The same life that was in Christ's spirit after resurrection comes into your spirit when you are born again. The law of the Spirit of life replaces the law of sin and death. The body of sin, the old enhousement of spiritual death, is destroyed.

Some Greek aids and translations mark these spirit references correctly with a small "s," though many English readers miss it. When the Holy Spirit is your Teacher, He can guide you into the truth even where translators and traditions have clouded it.

When I taught that the body of sin in Romans 6 referred to the old spirit man, not the physical body, it was far outside the religious vein. But the Spirit took the surrounding chapters and lifted that verse up until it became clear. Later, those who checked the Greek carefully found the same direction.

This gives me great confidence. If the Holy Spirit is your Teacher, He is a tremendous inoculation against deception.

The old man was crucified with Christ so the body of sin might be destroyed. Sin lost dominion because the nature changed.

Inside your spirit, the law of sin and death was canceled by the law of the Spirit of life. The Spirit of life is the born-again human spirit. The law emanating from it is the new nature, which cancels the law that emanated from the unregenerated spirit.

I have been born again. I no longer have a power plant generating the old nature. My flesh serves my new nature. I do not serve my flesh. Then God sent the third Person of the Godhead to teach me all about my inheritance.

Once I knew I was free and that God is immutable, sovereign, and love, I knew I had to walk free. Now I know He wants to save this city. When He put Jesus on the cross, He believed a people would rise who would take cities.

All God needs is an atmosphere to send people into and an atmosphere to fall on the city. I want the city to migrate toward a teaching center by nightfall. I want bars closed, and I want the gospel to overtake the territory.

Joe Public and Mary Wallpaper can walk in this. God wants you to go into the rooms of your relatives and have them fall under conviction because His presence follows you.

These signs follow those who believe. There ought to be a trail of discarded wheelchairs behind us.

Under the shadow, God protected the seed. He told Pharaoh to let His firstborn go. Signs and wonders accompanied Israel out of Egypt because the seed was being carried.

Now we are the children of God. Jesus is not ashamed to call us brethren. He is our oldest living Brother, the Firstborn, and we are born of that seed.

If God judged nations to protect the seed that would make our born-again experience possible, what do you think He wants us to walk in now?

When I stood by the gate Abraham passed through on his journey, the Holy Spirit said, "Your born-again experience went through this gate." The whole promise was being carried by one man, and Abraham was faithful.

Brother Prakash was called the Rain Man in India. In his twenties, he packed his clothes and went village to village. He would go to drought areas and ask, "Will you believe my God is God if He breaks your drought?"

They would say yes. He would pray, clouds would form, and rain would fall. If Hindu priests claimed their gods did it, he would pray and the rain would stop, then pray again and it would start. He left village after village born again.

Many men had more fire when they began than when they finished because organized religion put the fire out. That should not happen to us. God wants signs and wonders as the testimony of a resurrected Christ.

We were not called to sit in a building, swap revelation, take offerings, and buy houses. We were called to go into dark places and declare that our God is God.

Jesus said the fathers ate manna and are dead. Yet He also told the Sadducees:

"I am the God of Abraham,
and the God of Isaac,
and the God of Jacob."

God is not the God of the dead, but of the living.

So were they dead or alive? They were alive, but spiritually dead. They existed, waiting in the Old Testament place of comfort. Abraham's bosom was a type of heaven, just as Solomon's temple was the fullest shadow of the true temple. It had degrees and places of comfort, but it was still not the Father's presence in the way the born-again now enters.

Jesus also said:

"No man hath ascended up to heaven,
but he that came down from heaven."

No man had seen the Father at any time except the only begotten Son. Enoch, Elijah, Abraham, Moses, and the faithful had a place of comfort, but no one was born from spiritual death into the Father's presence until Jesus, the Firstborn from the dead.

When the Firstborn rose, those who had waited in faith received the new nature and entered the presence of Jesus.